

Amiodarone

(Cordarone, Pacerone)

- I. Classification**
 - Anti-arrhythmic
- II. Action(s)**
 - Increases action potential duration and refractory period duration
 - Noncompetitive alpha and beta adrenergic inhibition
- III. Indication(s)**
 - Ventricular tachycardia and ventricular fibrillation
 - Wide complex tachycardia
 - Atrial arrhythmia refractory to other treatments
- IV. Contraindications**
 - Hypersensitivity to Amiodarone
 - Sinus bradycardia, 2nd or 3rd degree Heart Block
 - Cardiogenic shock
 - Severe CHF
- V. Precautions**
 - Hypotension frequently occurs
 - Do not mix with any other drugs
 - Precipitates with sodium bicarbonate
- VI. Drug interactions**
 - Quinolone antibiotics (cipro, Levaquin, etc)
- VII. Adult Dosing and Administration**
 - Cardiac Arrest VF / Pulseless V-Tach
 - 300 mg IV/IO push
 - If rhythm continues may administer a second bolus of 150 mg IV/IO
 - Wide-complex tachycardia with pulse, Narrow complex tachycardia refractory to other treatments (Consult Medical Direction)
 - 150 mg IV/IO over 10 minutes, mixed in 100cc NS and given via medication pump
- VIII. Pediatric Dosing and Administration**
 - Cardiac Arrest VF / Pulseless V-Tach 5 mg/kg IV/IO push
 - Wide-complex tachycardia with pulse – 5 mg/kg IV/IO mixed in 100 cc NS and given over 10 minutes
 - Max dose is 15 mg/kg or max adult dose
- IX. Onset**
 - 2-5 minutes
- X. Duration**
 - Very long half-life – several days
- XI. Possible Adverse Effects**
 - Dizziness, headache,
 - Hypotension
 - Bradycardia, AV Blocks, Ventricular dysrhythmias
 - Nausea/Vomiting, anorexia
 - Dyspnea, Pulmonary toxicity, CHF